MCLENNAN COMMUNITY COLLEGE

AI-Powered Course Design

FROM OER RESOURCES TO READY-TO-TEACH COURSES

One useful outcome

Build one course component you can use, with a workflow you can repeat.

Where are you starting?

Free tools	MCC Copilot	Paid plan

Every activity today works with MCC Copilot.

AI is a design partner, not a vending machine

1

DIRECT

Goals, audience, values

2

REVIEW

Read what it drafted

3

REVISE

Until it fits your course

You stay the designer.

Why AI and OER fit together

OER

THE RAW MATERIAL

Openly licensed. Adaptable. Built to be remixed.

AI

THE ACCELERATOR

Drafts fast. Needs your judgment.

Open content + clear direction = a usable first draft

Where to find OER

OER COMMONS

oercommons.org

Global library. Filter by subject, level, and license.

OERTX

oertx.highered.texas.gov

Texas collections: Core, co-requisite, and CTE.

Search both. Start with OERTX for Texas courses.

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How to search for OER

STANDARD

Discipline + “open textbook”

Filter by level and license

oertx.highered.texas.gov

oercommons.org

AI-ASSISTED

Ask for search terms, not titles

Use a tool that cites sources

Open every link

AI suggests. You verify.

Two workflows, one approach

A
PAID TOOLS

A whole course, unit by unit

B
FREE TOOLS

One module, one component at a time

Not sure? Start with Workflow B.

Today’s three-tool arc

1
ANCHOR
Learn the skill

2
PRACTICE
See it in action

3
APPLY
Build Spring course

Same tool, better direction

WEAK

“Write learning objectives for a reading unit.”

CONSTRAINT-RICH

Audience · reading level · OER source · format · values

Then correct it, and say why.

Six moves that travel

SET CONTEXT
Standards up front

ASSESS FIRST
Review before rewriting

CORRECT
Say why it's wrong

ASK WHY
Invite pushback

DECIDE FIRST
Settle choices, then build

KEEP IT OER
Back to the source

Same moves, any tool. Paid and free versions are in your handout.

Workflow: the INRW 0301 build

1

SET UP & MAP

OER + instructions → map

2

TEMPLATE

Set constraints. Perfect design.

3

BUILD & VERIFY

One unit at a time. Check every page.

Map → template → four unit guides → Brightspace

Workflow: the Composition II build

1

SET UP & MAP

Instructor Plan + course package → OER + map

2

TEMPLATE

Set constraints. Perfect design.

3

BUILD & VERIFY

One unit at a time. Check every page.

Map → template → four unit guides → Brightspace

Match the free tool to the job

CHATGPT
Lots of back-and-forth

CLAUDE
Longer documents

COPILOT
Already in MCC tools

PERPLEXITY
Sources with citations

Small requests · context block · decisions log

Your turn: copilot.microsoft.com

1

CONTEXT

Provide sources. Set constraints.

2

ASSESS

Review output. Push back.

3

NAME THE NEED

Clarify expectations.

4

BUILD

From the OER materials

Iterate once: prompt → read → refine

Check before you use it

ACCURATE

Every fact correct

ALIGNED

Serves the objective

APPROPRIATE

Right for your students

COHERENT

Fits the course

The tool drafts. You decide.

Apply the workflow, responsibly

Copilot is already yours through MCC.

LICENSE

Check OER license + attribution

INTEGRITY

Protect what students see

TRANSPARENCY

Say how AI was used

Your next step: the handout's “In Today's Session” table

Thank you

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